Jewel Flow Chat: feature walkthrough

A walkthrough of every screen, option and rule in the customer–merchant chat, for design, product and engineering. Prototype: **Enquiry v5.dc.html**. Screens below are captured from it.

CUSTOMER	MERCHANT	STORE TEAM
Ananya Rao	**Krishna Jewellers**	**Suresh, Priya, Karthik**
Follows Krishna Jewellers and Sri Lakshmi Jewels	Signed in as Suresh	Anyone on the team can reply

1. What the feature does

Customers and stores talk in a chat that works like WhatsApp. Customers can ask about one product or many, or just send a message without a product. Inside the chat, each product gets its own discussion, so several products don't get mixed up. Anyone on the store team can reply, and every reply shows who sent it.

- One chat per customer and store. Starting a chat never asks what it is about.
- Product discussions sit inside the chat. The newest is open and older ones fold into cards that can be reopened with a tap.
- Either side can close a product discussion or the whole chat, and either side can reopen it.
- The only alert is an unread count. There are no “needs reply” labels.

2. Key terms

Term	Meaning
Chat	The full conversation between one customer and one store.
Product discussion	The messages about a single product inside a chat. It is either open or closed.
General message	A message not tied to any product. It shows in the main chat flow.
Ticket	A number for each open period of a chat (for example #1038). Reopening a closed chat gives it a new number. It is used for tracking only and appears in chat details and in the reopen line.
Staff name	The name of the team member who sent a store message, shown above their bubble.
Quick replies	Saved phrases shown above the merchant's keyboard. Tap one to fill the message box.
Auto reply	A message the store sends automatically, once, the first time a customer asks about a product.

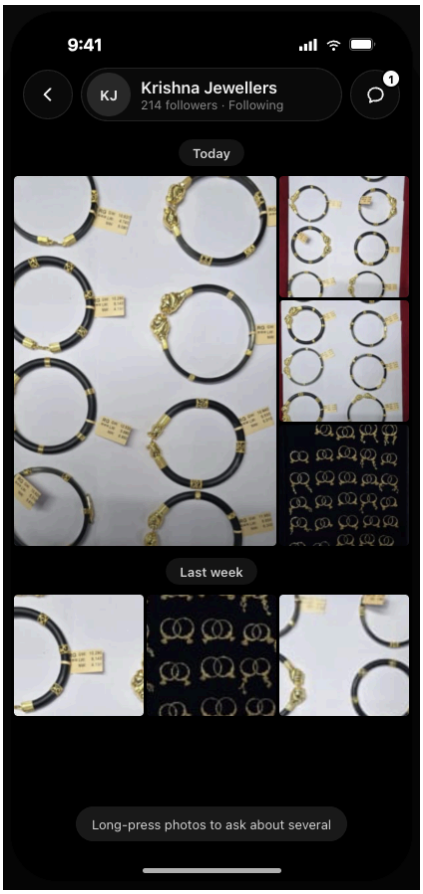
3. Customer screens

3.1 Store page and starting a chat

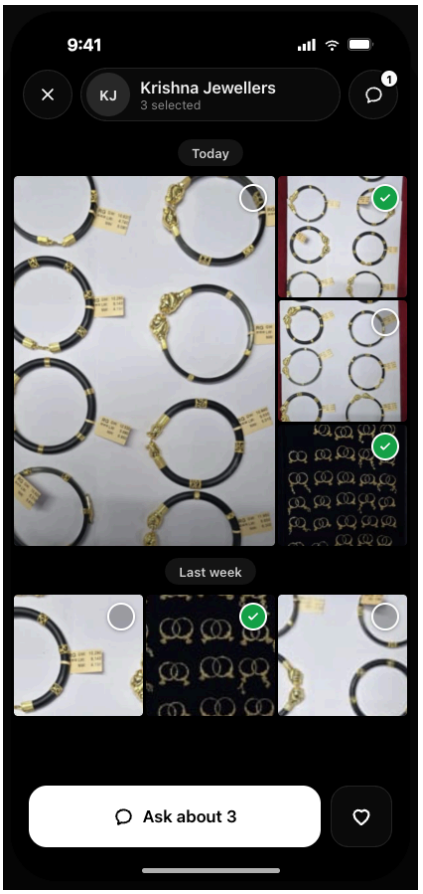
The store page shows the catalogue grouped by upload date. The chat button at the top right opens the chat with this store straight away. Its badge shows unread messages from this store. A hint at the bottom tells first-time users they can long-press photos to ask about several at once.

3.2 Asking about several products

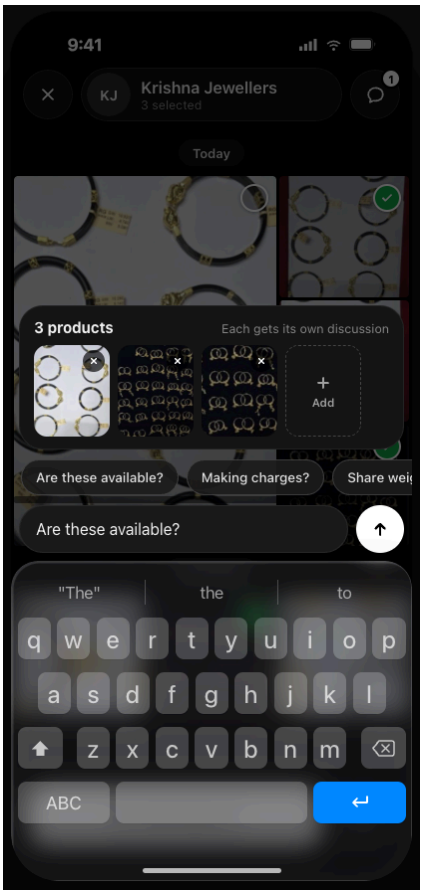
Long-press any photo to start selecting, the same gesture as Cart. Selected tiles get a green check, and the header shows “3 selected”. **Ask about 3** opens the enquiry basket: thumbnails of the chosen products (each can be removed with ×), an Add tile to go back and pick more, suggested questions, and a message box. One message is sent, and each product gets its own discussion in the chat.



A. Store page with chat button



B. Long-press to select



C. Enquiry basket

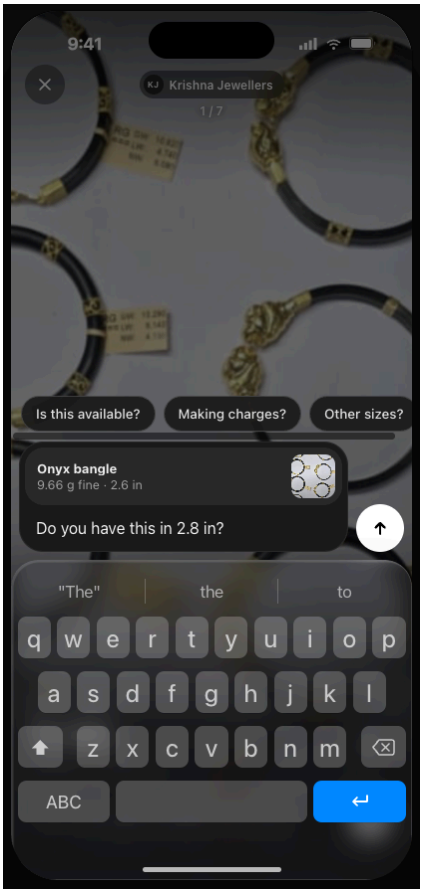
3.3 Asking from the product viewer

Opening a photo shows it full screen with its fine weight, metal and net weight. Like and Add to cart are on the right. The bar at the bottom reads “Ask Krishna Jewellers about this”. Tapping it, or swiping up, opens the message box with the product attached and three suggested questions.

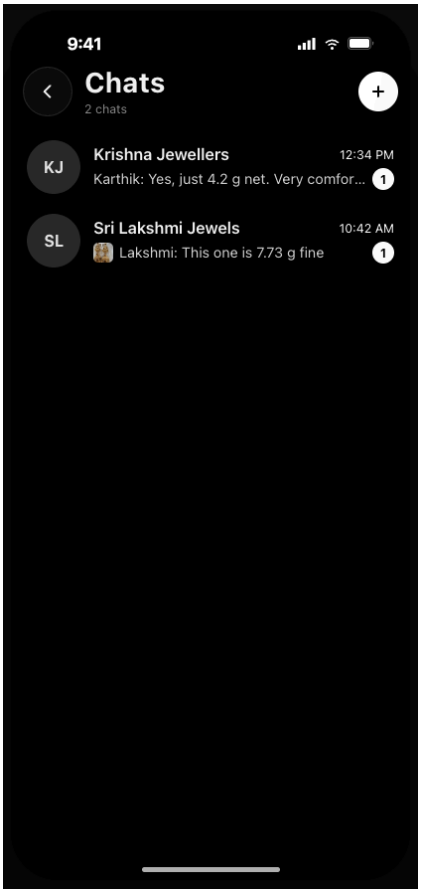
After sending, a toast confirms “Sent to Krishna Jewellers” with an **Open chat** button.

3.4 Chats list and new chat

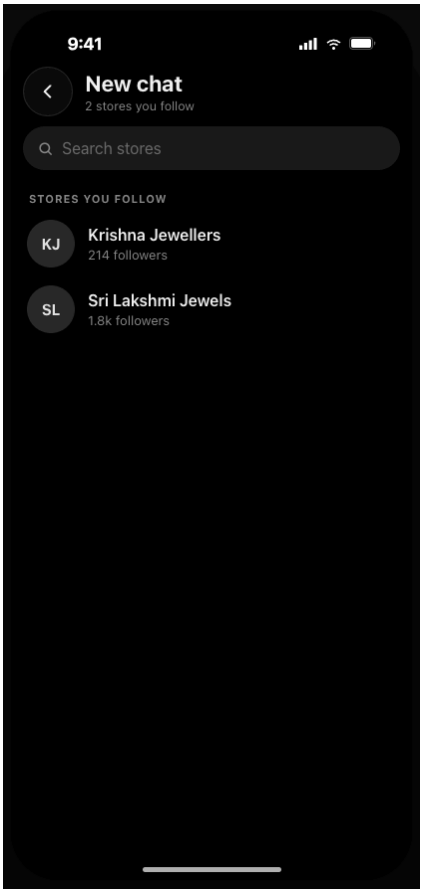
The Chats list shows one row per store: avatar, name, time, last message (with the staff member's name, for example “Lakshmi: This one is 7.73 g fine”), and an unread count. **+** opens New chat, a searchable list of stores the customer follows. Tapping a store opens the chat with that store, or creates one if none exists.



D. Asking from the viewer



E. Customer chats list



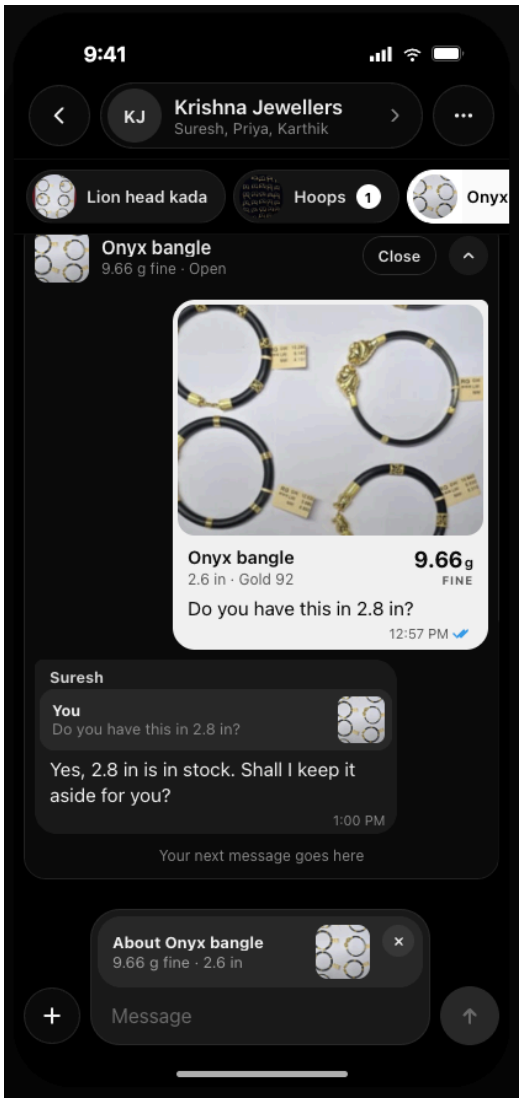
F. New chat: stores you follow

4. Inside a chat

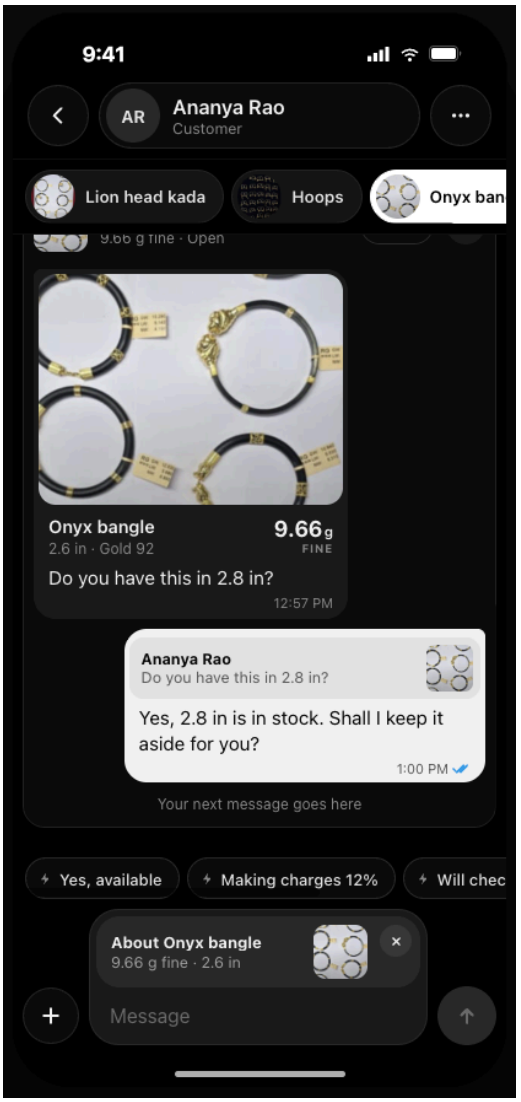
Customers and merchants see the same chat layout. Your own messages are on the right in light bubbles. Messages from the other side are on the left in dark bubbles.

4.1 Anatomy

1. **Header.** Back button, then the other party's name. Below the name, customers see the store team (“Suresh, Priya, Karthik”) and merchants see “Customer” or “Store account”. Typing replaces this line (“Priya is typing…”). Customers can tap the name to open the store page. ⋯ opens chat details.
2. **Product chips.** Shown only when two or more products are in the chat. Each chip has a photo, name and unread count. The open discussion's chip is white. Tapping a chip opens and scrolls to that discussion. Closed discussions appear faded.
3. **Timeline.** General messages, day separators, status lines, and product discussions (one open, the rest folded).
4. **Message box.** “+” shares a product. When a discussion is open, an *About [product]* chip shows where the message will go; tap × to send a general message instead. Merchants also see quick replies above the box.



G. Customer view. Suresh's name is on his reply.

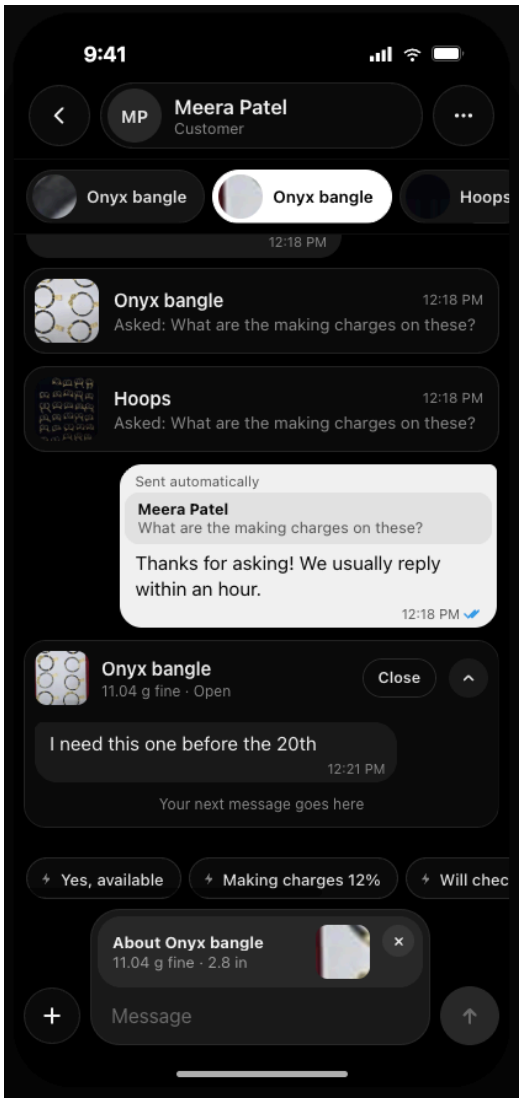


H. Merchant view of the same chat, with quick replies

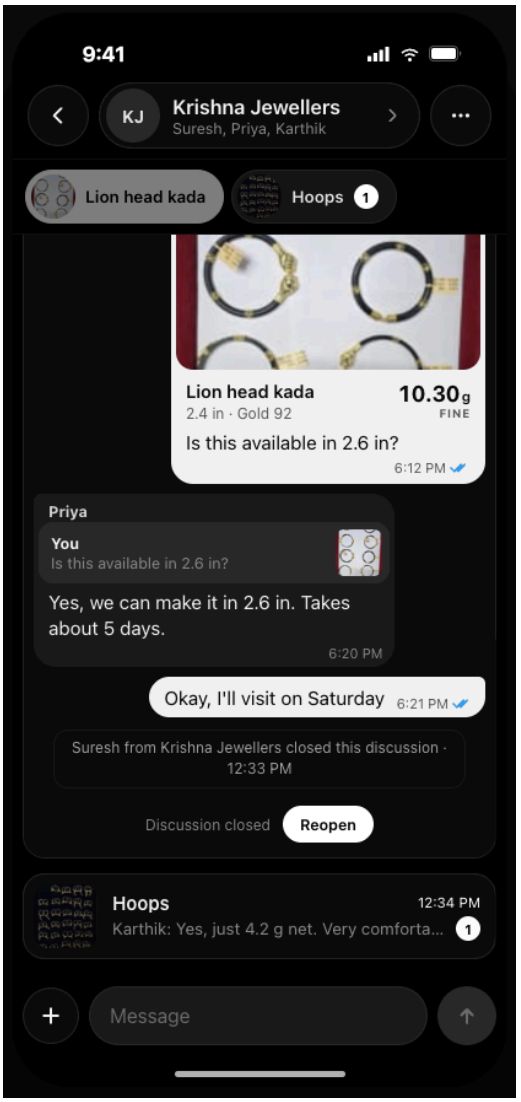
4.2 Product discussions

Every product in a chat has its own discussion. This keeps conversations about several products apart.

- **Open discussion:** a bordered panel with the product photo, name, fine weight and status, its messages, and “Your next message goes here” at the bottom. The header has **Close** and a collapse arrow.
- **Folded discussion:** a card with photo, name, last message with sender (“Karthik: Yes, just 4.2 g net…”), time and unread count. Tap to open it.
- **Only one open at a time.** When a message arrives about a different product, that discussion opens and the previous one folds. If someone has opened a discussion by hand, it stays open until they send a message or collapse it.
- **Position:** each discussion sits in the timeline at its latest message. A new reply in an old discussion moves it to the bottom.
- **Several products at once:** the customer's basket message shows as a 2×2 photo grid in the main flow. Each product in it gets its own folded card. Tapping a photo in the grid opens that product's discussion.



I. Three-product enquiry: two folded, one open. The automatic reply is marked only for the merchant.



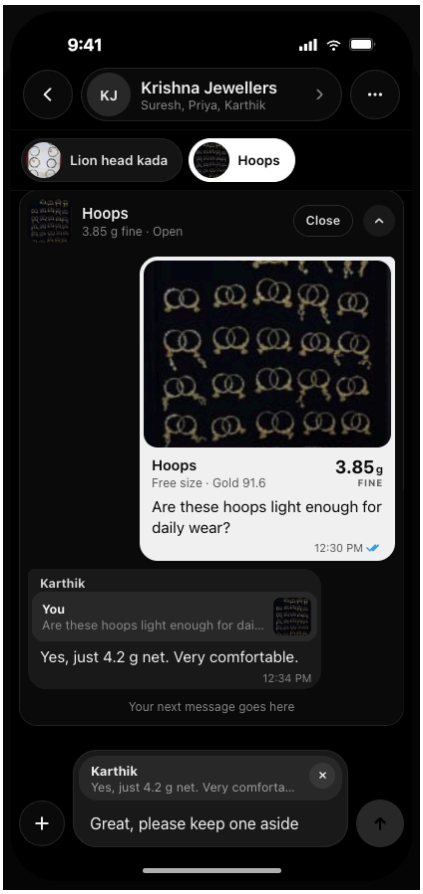
J. A closed discussion with Reopen. Hoops is folded below with 1 unread.

4.3 Where a message goes

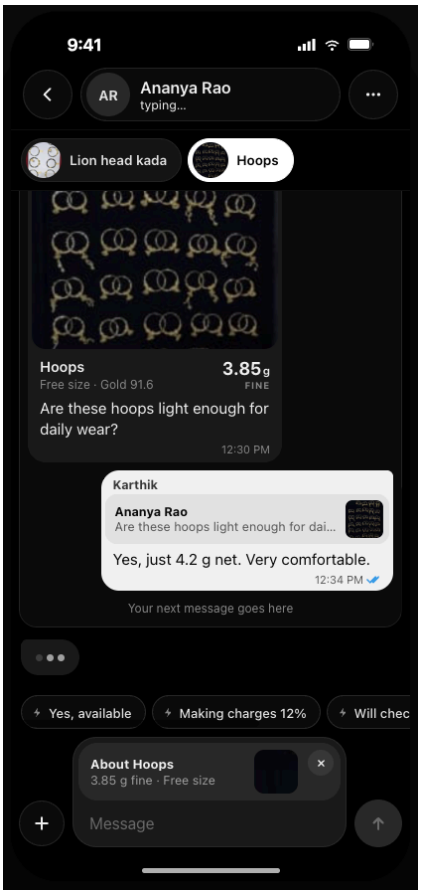
Action	Lands in
Type while a discussion is open	That discussion
Type after clearing the *About* chip	Main chat flow (general)
Swipe right on a message to reply	The same place as the message being replied to
Customer shares a product with +, or asks from the store or viewer	That product's discussion, which is created if new
Merchant shares a product with + while a discussion is open	The open discussion, as a suggested alternative
Customer asks about a product whose discussion was closed	That discussion, reopened automatically with a status line

4.4 Replying, sharing and typing

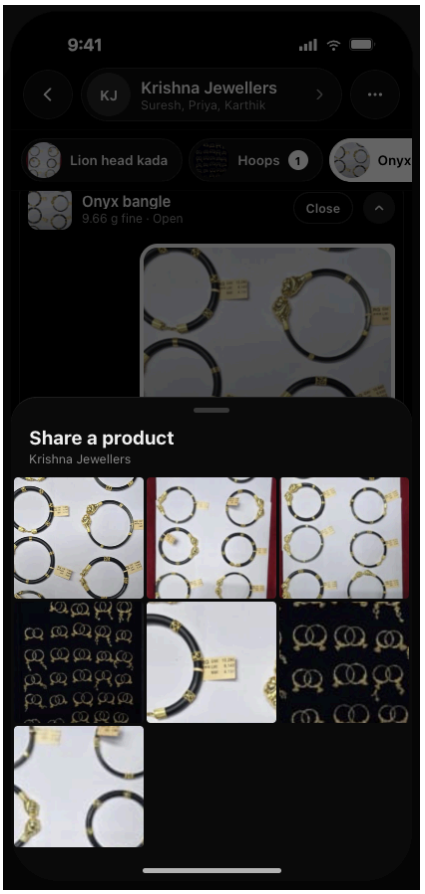
Swipe right on any bubble to reply. A reply arrow appears while dragging, and the message box shows a quote of the original, with a thumbnail if it was a product. The sent message carries that quote. **+** opens “Share a product”, a 3-column grid of the store's catalogue. Customers pick from the store's catalogue and merchants from their own. Typing shows on both sides, as dots in the chat and as “typing…” in the header and chat list.



K. Replying to Karthik's message



L. Merchant sees “typing…”



M. Share a product

4.5 Who replied

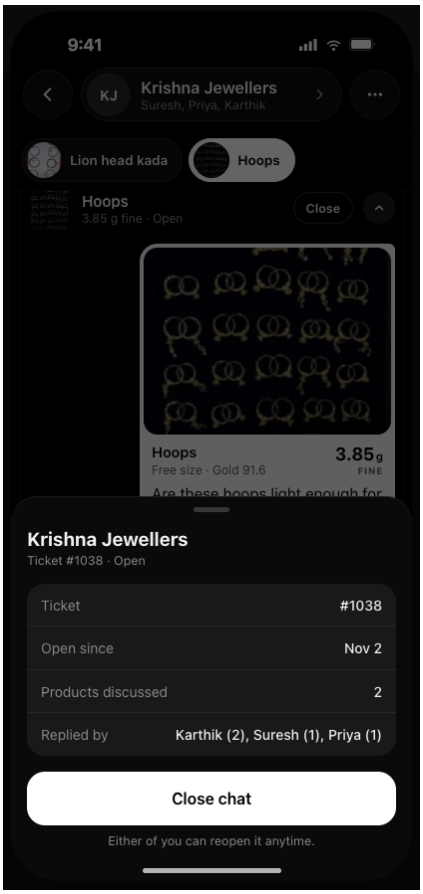
So the store is accountable, every store message carries the sender's name:

- **Customer side:** the name sits above every group of store messages (“Priya”, “Karthik”). Chat list previews and folded cards use the same name (“Karthik: …”). The header lists the store team.
- **Merchant side:** your own messages show no name. Colleagues' messages show their name, so the team can see who handled what.
- **Chat details** lists “Replied by” with a count per person, for example “Karthik (2), Suresh (2), Priya (1)”.
- **Automatic replies** show no staff name.

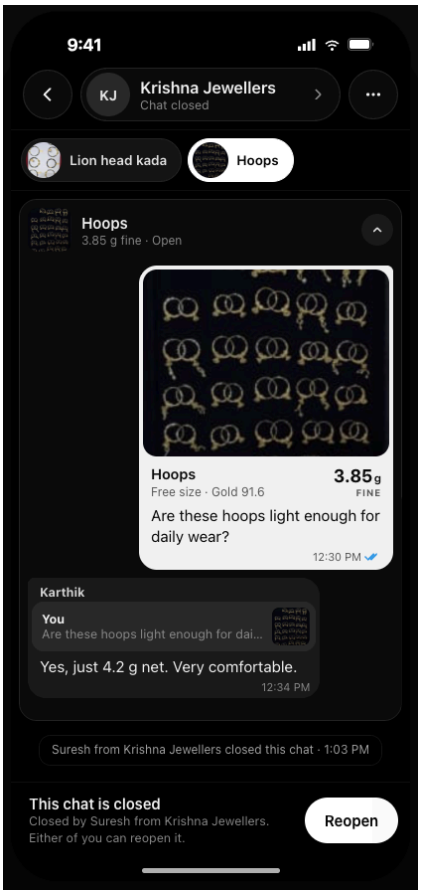
4.6 Chat details, closing and reopening

⋯ in the header opens Chat details: ticket number, open since, products discussed, replied by, and a **Close chat** button with the note “Either of you can reopen it anytime.” Closing adds a status line (“You closed this chat · 1:05 PM”) and replaces the message box with “This chat is closed” and **Reopen**. Either side can reopen. Reopening adds “Ananya reopened this chat as Ticket #1045”.

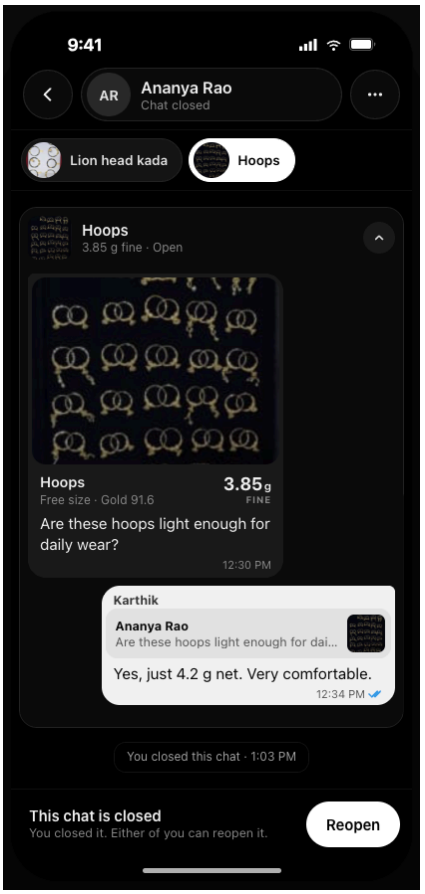
Individual product discussions close and reopen the same way, from the Close button in the panel header. Closing the whole chat hides the Close and Reopen buttons on its discussions until the chat is reopened.



N. Chat details



O. Closed chat, customer



P. Closed chat, merchant

5. Merchant tools

5.1 Chats list

The subtitle shows the store and who is signed in (“Krishna Jewellers · signed in as Suresh”). Rows match the customer list: avatar, name, a *Store* tag for business buyers, last message with the sender's name if it came from a colleague, read ticks on the merchant's own messages, and an unread count. **+** opens New chat with a searchable list of customers who follow the store.

5.2 By product

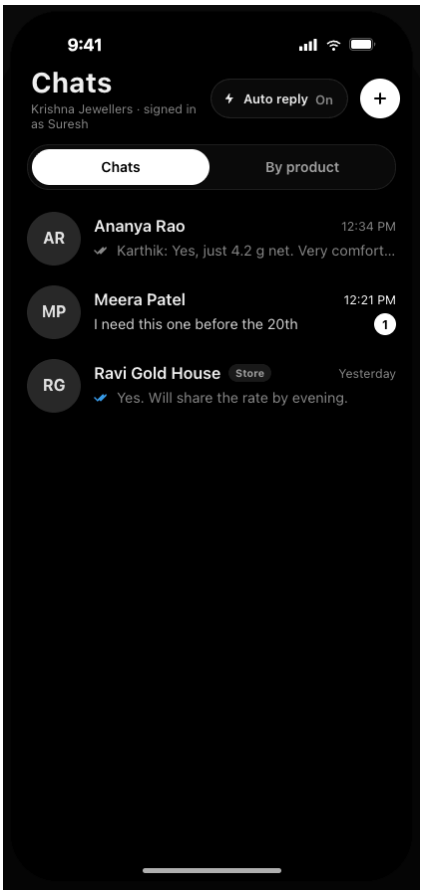
A second tab lists every product customers have asked about, newest first: photo, name, fine weight, how many customers asked, and a chip per customer with their unread count. Tapping a customer opens their chat with that product's discussion open.

5.3 Auto reply and quick replies

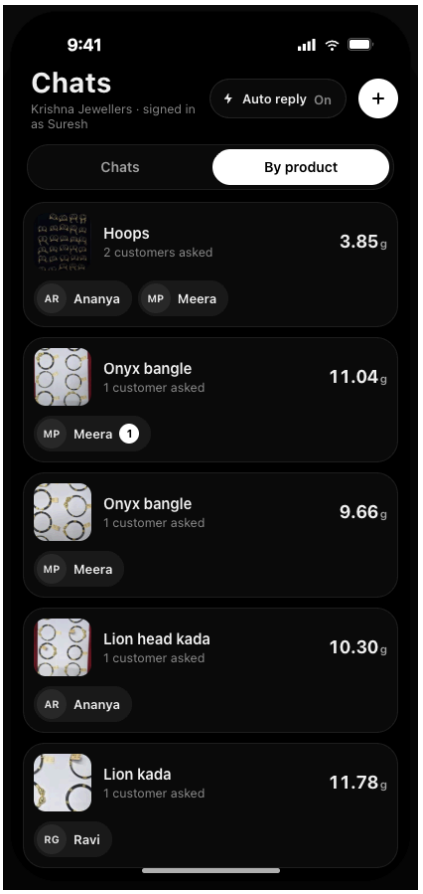
The **Auto reply** button in the Chats header shows On or Off and opens a sheet with:

- An on/off switch and the message text. The message is sent once, the first time a customer asks about a product.
- The list of quick replies, which can be removed or added. These appear as chips above the merchant's keyboard in every chat.

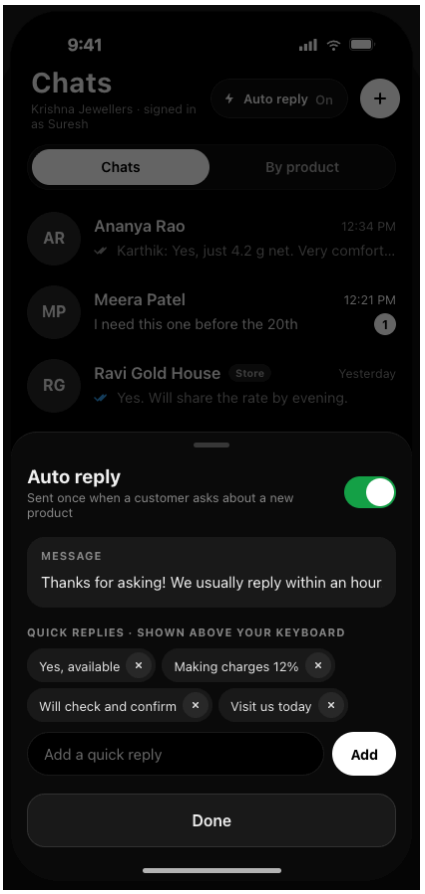
Customers see an auto reply as a normal store message, with no label. Merchants see a muted “Sent automatically” line on it.



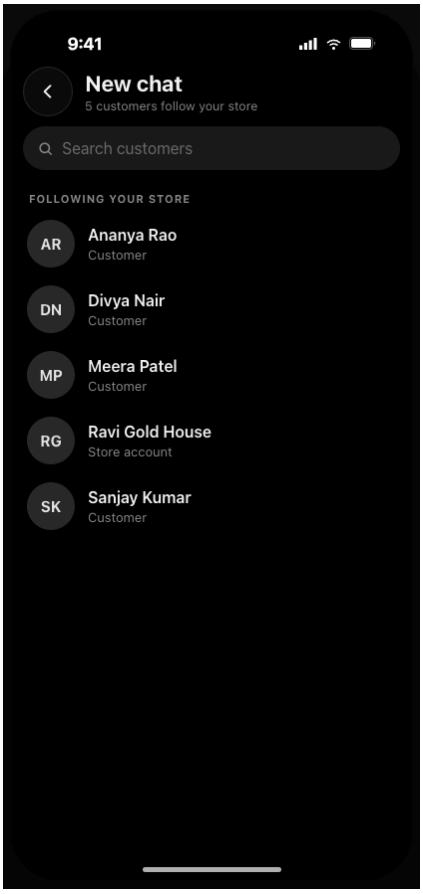
Q. Merchant chats list



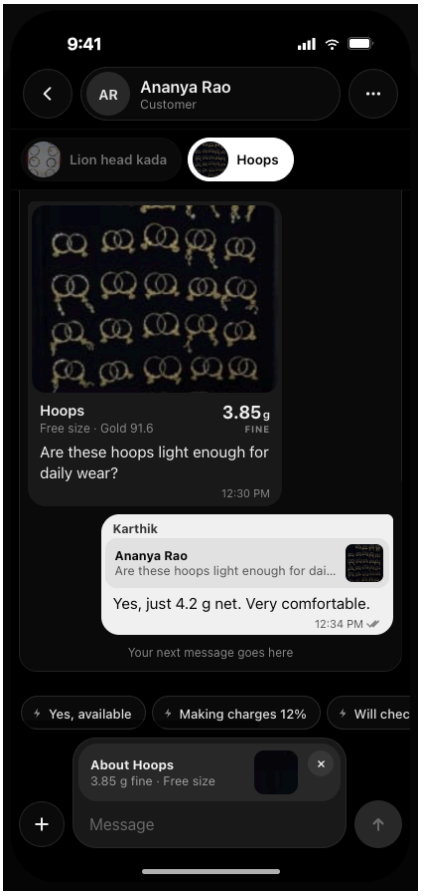
R. By product



S. Auto reply and quick replies



T. New chat: customers who follow the store



U. Merchant view: closed discussion folded above the open one

6. Indicators

Indicator	Meaning
One grey tick	Sent
Two grey ticks	Delivered
Two blue ticks	Read. A message in a folded discussion counts as read only once that discussion is opened.
White count badge	Unread messages, on the chat button, chat rows, product chips, folded cards and By product chips
“Name is typing…”	The other side is typing. Customers see the staff member's name; merchants see “typing…”.
Status line (centred)	Closed or reopened events for the chat or a discussion, with who did it and when

7. Rules and edge cases

- There is one chat per customer and store pair. Opening a chat from the store page, the viewer, the basket or New chat always goes to the same conversation.
- An empty chat (opened from New chat, nothing sent yet) does not appear in either Chats list.
- A basket of several products sends one message, which creates one discussion per product.
- Auto reply goes out only for products new to that chat, never twice for the same product.
- While a chat is closed there is no message box, but asking about a product from the store page reopens it.
- Unread counts in the list include messages in folded discussions until those are opened.
- Ticket numbers go up per store, and each reopen takes the next number.

8. Colours outside the design system

The chat uses the design system's neutral greys. Two extra colours remain: blue **#3B9BE8** for read ticks and green **#16A34A** for selection checks and switches. The amber used for “to reply” earlier has been removed.

9. Prototype start states

Set *Start screen* in the prototype's Tweaks to jump straight to a state. *Layout* switches between both phones, customer only, or merchant only.

Value	Shows
`store / stores`	Store page / list of followed stores
`storeSel / basket`	Multi-select / enquiry basket
`viewer / compose`	Product viewer / asking from the viewer
`inbox / newChat`	Chats lists / New chat contact picker
`chat / attach`	Live chat on both phones / Share a product sheet
`productThread`	Merchant view of a three-product enquiry
`merchantTrack / autoReply`	By product tab / auto reply sheet
`chatInfo / closedChat`	Chat details / closed chat